

Spending with intention and attention

This is really the definition of mindful spending – ensuring that you are giving all of your transactions your full attention, and that you are spending because you really want or need to. It sounds incredibly simple but, as you will know from experience, requires discipline and strength. As we've repeatedly seen, the choices that contribute positively to our financial wellbeing often do not lie on the path of least resistance; they are challenging, and they force us to confront things that aren't always comfortable. In order to start putting our mindful spending theory into practice, we need to apply these principles of intention and attention to all of our purchases going forward, giving ourselves the time and space that we need to make informed choices where possible.

It is up to you to decide the parameters of your own decision-making process when it comes to parting with your money – you need to be able to trust yourself to make the right choice for you as part of your ongoing financial wellbeing practice. Here are a few prompts and enquiries that you can make of yourself, though, before you head to the checkout or press the 'pay now' button.

You don't need to make all of your purchasing decisions based purely on affordability, by which I mean that just because you can afford to buy something, doesn't mean that you have to. It's a question of priorities, and whether you would rather invest the money in this product, or in something else.